and government to translate research into real-world applications and market-ready solutions.

The institute recently undertook a comprehensive curriculum revamp across all levels—undergraduate, postgraduate and doctoral. Effective from the 2025–26 academic year, the new curriculum reflects themes such as flexibility, hands-on learning, sustainability, ethical reasoning and technological foresight, including AI and machine learning. For MTech and MS (Research) students, the structure is now more outcome-oriented, with greater industry engagement and the option to undertake master's theses within industry settings.

A PhD conversion option has also been built in for postgraduate students, while undergraduate students can now seamlessly transition into an MTech programme after three years, making them eligible for a five-year dual degree. Doctoral training has similarly been formalised, with a focus on producing independent, ethically grounded researchers.

Meanwhile, the Kusuma School of Biological Sciences has launched a new MSc programme with a strong emphasis on quantitative biology

TOP 5

FIVE TECHNICAL UNIVERSITIES WITH BEST VALUE FOR MONEY

RANK	UNIVERSITY	RoI
1	INDIAN INSTITUTE OF TECHNOLOGY ROORKEE	96.5
2	INDIAN INSTITUTE OF TECHNOLOGY KANPUR	73.5
3	INDIAN INSTITUTE OF TECHNOLOGY GUWAHATI	72.8
4	INDIAN INSTITUTE OF TECHNOLOGY KHARAGPUR*	60.6
5	INDIAN INSTITUTE OF TECHNOLOGY GANDHINAGAR	38.6

Note: RoI or return on investment is calculated based on average annual salary (MTech) / tuition fees (MTech entire duration)
**For IIT Kharagpur, current publicly available data used*

GUEST COLUMN



PROF. RANGAN BANERJEE
Director, IIT Delhi

A Curriculum for Gen Next

This has been an eventful year. After nearly 12-13 years, we have completely revamped our curriculum. The changes are centred on flexibility, hands-on learning and preparing students for interdisciplinary careers. Every student—whether in undergraduate, master's or doctoral programmes—will now engage with concepts in Artificial Intelligence and sustainability, essential for any future career.

At the master's level, students will now take part in a capstone project, fostering teamwork and real-world problem-solving. There is also an increased focus on communication, internships with industry and a recalibrated credit structure to enhance academic depth. PhD programmes have similarly evolved. While depth in research remains central, the structure now includes elements of breadth—ranging from teaching practicum to research communication. Our goal is to ensure that doctoral candidates are not only strong researchers but are also prepared for academic or industry roles.

"Every student—whether in UG, PG or PhD—will now engage with concepts in AI and sustainability, essential for any future career"

Recognising the fast-changing nature of work, IIT Delhi has deepened its ties with industry over the past year. This includes the launch of a Hyundai research centre—one of the company's few facilities outside Korea—which also involves IIT Bombay and IIT Madras. It will function as a national research centre, focused on areas relevant to industry. Entrepreneurship, especially among master's and doctoral students, is being actively promoted. If students—across UG and PG levels—come up with a strong idea, we support them to turn it into a startup.

Student well-being remains a core concern, especially in high-pressure academic environments. IIT Delhi has scaled up its mental health infrastructure significantly in the last year. This includes 24x7 counsellor access, online support tools and a more robust academic support system. ■

—as told to Shelly Anand